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ATTRACTION: Ashoka Pillar & Kolhua Stupa

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

The Lion Pillar at Kolhua

LOCATION:

Kolhua, near Vaishali

DISTRICT / REGION:

Vaishali Region

CATEGORY:

Historical Site / Monument

OVERVIEW:

The Ashoka Pillar & Kolhua Stupa in Vaishali commemorate a monumental event in Buddhist history: Lord Buddha's last sermon. Erected by Emperor Ashoka in the third century BCE, the site features a highly polished red sandstone pillar with a majestic life-size lion figure perched on top, situated beside a historic brick stupa.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Located at Kolhua, the site boasts an impressive, highly polished pillar made of red sandstone. The pillar is topped by a bell-shaped capital that supports a life-size lion figure. This Lion Pillar was erected by Emperor Ashoka to mark the sacred spot where Lord Buddha preached his last sermon. Placed alongside the pillar is an ancient brick stupa, adding to the archaeological and religious grandeur of the location.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Lord Buddha visited Vaishali numerous times and delivered his final sermon at Kolhua. To honor this sacred event, Emperor Ashoka erected the Lion Pillar in the 3rd century BCE. It stands as a testament to the spread of Buddhism and Mauryan architectural brilliance.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

It is believed to be the exact location of Buddha's last sermon before his journey to Mahaparinirvana.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Highly polished red sandstone pillar from the 3rd century BCE.
- Bell-shaped capital with a life-size lion figure on top.
- Ancient brick stupa situated beside the pillar.
- Marks the site of Buddha's last sermon.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

Not Mentioned

Opening Hours:

Not Mentioned

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Not Mentioned

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Not Mentioned

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Jay Prakash Narayan International Airport (Patna)

Distance From Airport:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Railway Station:

Hajipur and Muzaffarpur Railway Station

Distance From Railway Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Distance From Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Road Connectivity:

Vaishali is well connected by road. Bus and Taxi Services can be used to reach here.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Police Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Medical Facility:

Not Mentioned

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Budha Stupa-I
- Budha Stupa-II
- Vishwa Shanti Stupa
- Abhishek Pushkarni (Coronation Tank)
- Vaishali Museum

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

Not Mentioned

HOTELS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL GUIDES:

Not Mentioned

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

Not Mentioned

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Built by Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE.
- The pillar is made of highly polished red sandstone.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

The Ashoka Pillar and Kolhua Stupa near Vaishali are monumental 3rd-century BCE structures erected by Emperor Ashoka. The site features a highly polished red sandstone pillar topped with a life-size lion on a bell-shaped capital, standing beside a brick stupa. It marks the sacred spot where Lord Buddha delivered his last sermon. Accessible via Patna Airport and Hajipur/Muzaffarpur railways.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known for the 3rd-century BCE Ashoka Lion Pillar and a brick stupa commemorating Lord Buddha's last sermon.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located at Kolhua, near Vaishali.

Q: What does the pillar look like?

A: It is a highly polished pillar of red sandstone, topped by a bell-shaped capital with a life-size lion figure on top.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: The nearest airport is in Patna, and the nearest railway stations are Hajipur and Muzaffarpur.

KEYWORDS:

Ashoka Pillar, Kolhua Stupa, Vaishali, Lion Pillar, Red Sandstone, Buddha Last Sermon, Maurya Period, Buddhist Circuit.

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